

23 Asking polite questions

In English, asking questions directly can sometimes be seen as impolite. It is very common for English speakers to make their questions more indirect.

 **New language** Direct and indirect questions

Aa Vocabulary Job interviews

 **New skill** Asking questions politely

23.1 KEY LANGUAGE POLITE OPEN QUESTIONS

If an indirect question contains "to be," this verb comes after the subject.

What are your career goals?



Could you tell me what your career goals are?

Polite questions usually start with one of these phrases.

The auxiliary verb "to have" also comes after the subject in indirect questions.

What have you designed before?



I was wondering what you have designed before.

The auxiliary verb "to do" does not appear in indirect questions.

Why do you enjoy working in fashion?



I'd like to know why you enjoy working in fashion.



23.2 REWRITE THE DIRECT QUESTIONS AS INDIRECT QUESTIONS

What are your strengths?

Could you tell me what your strengths are?

① When are you available?

I was wondering _____

② Why have you applied for this job?

I'd like to know _____

③ What is our best-selling product?

Do you have any idea _____

④ Who was your last manager?

I'm curious to know _____

